What can AI Do in Legal?

An Overview of Use Cases

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Review of Last Presentation

Last presentation on AI/ML/NLP Basic Terminology here.

Artificial Intelligence (AI): Systems that can do intelligent things

Machine Learning (ML): AI that can recognize patterns from large amounts of data

Natural Language Processing (NLP): An AI model that understands natural language.

The mission of the Atticus Project: Open-source a collection of labeled legal contracts for AI training purposes, so that contract review tools can improve their accuracy and comprehensiveness.

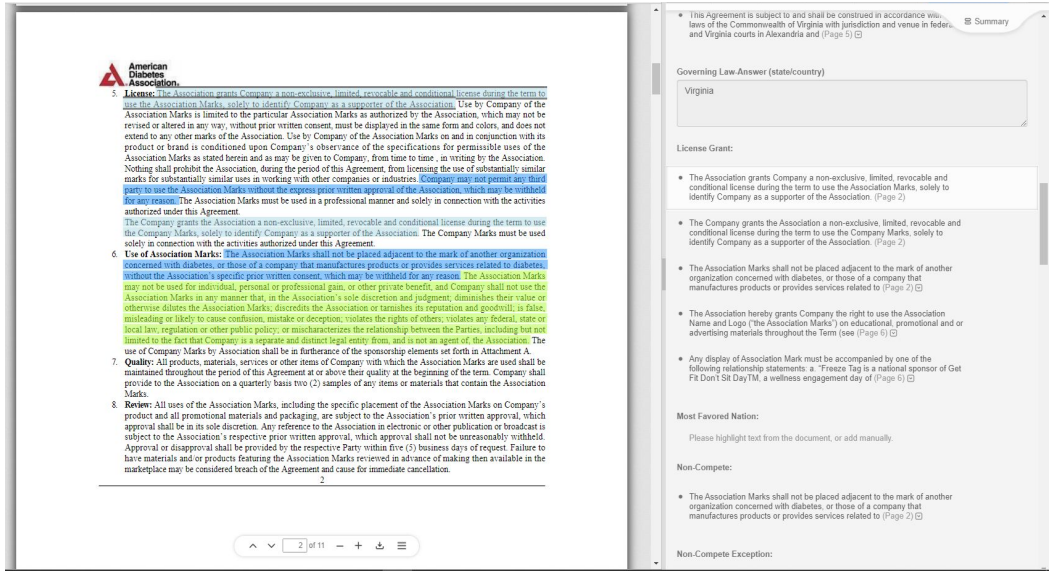
AI Legal Use Cases

- Contract review
- Automatic redaction
- Document automation
- Legal research/e-discovery
- Predicting case results
- E-billing
- Flagging loopholes
- Automatic deadline reminders

Contract Review

By analyzing patterns in phrasing across contracts, we can use ML to detect different clauses of a contract and “read” it much faster than a human can manually.

Through this, we can automate the low-level, menial aspects of due diligence.



Automatic Redaction

We can use ML to redact clauses (or portions thereof) such as personal information or confidential provisions in a contract or legal document.

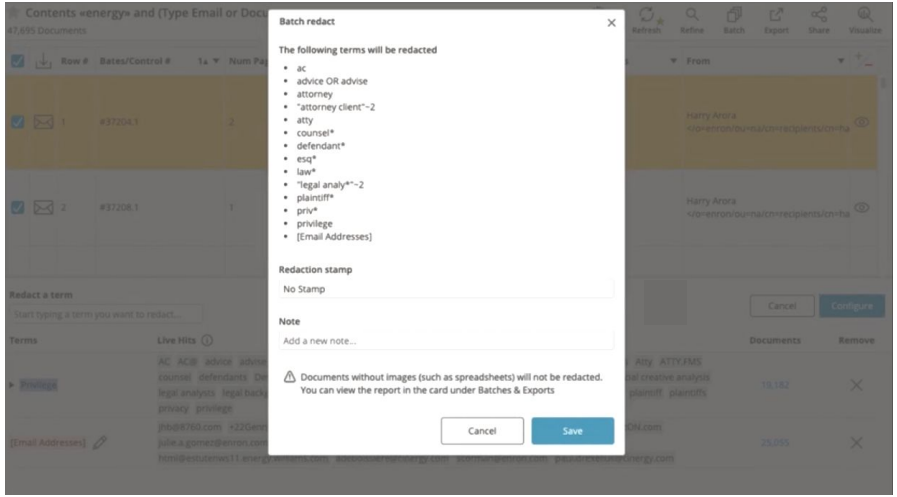


Image from Everlaw

Document Automation

An AI model that has learned the typical structure for various clauses of a contract can then be used to automatically fill out documents based on user input.

This is especially useful in areas such as patent applications or customer contracts, where manual drafting is not only costly but sometimes simply too slow.

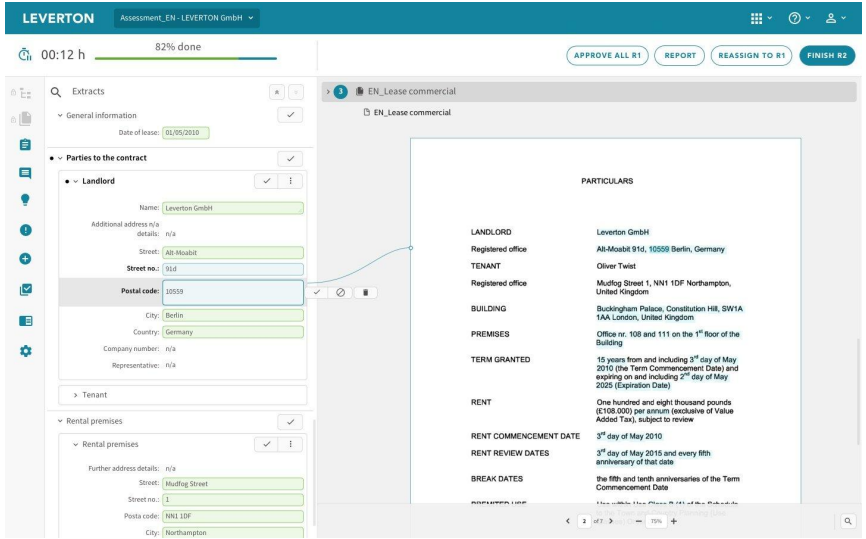


Image from Leverton

e-Discovery

We can use ML to quickly classify thousands of documents as relevant or irrelevant in a search for specific information.

These models can provide the user with a score of how relevant they believe a document to be and generate a summary of the document and its key components.

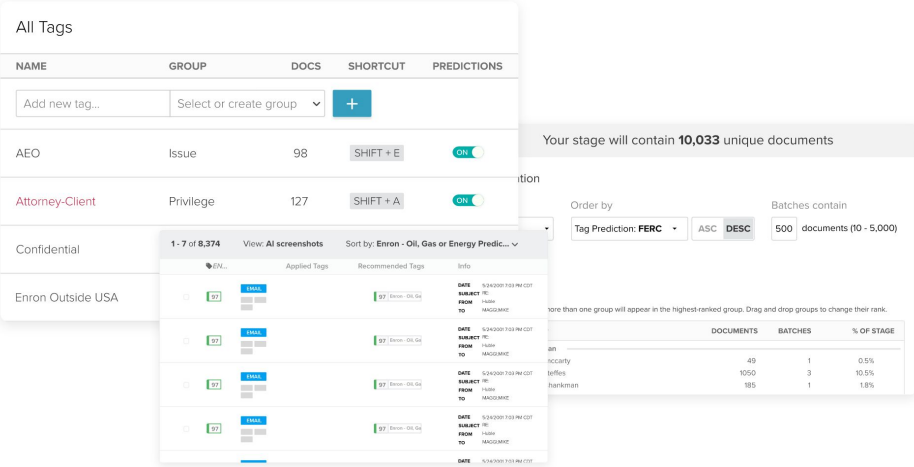


Image from DISCO

Legal Research

We can use ML alongside NLP to take a question from users and scan the web and database for relevant statutes, regulations, case law, and recommended readings, etc.

These systems are better than traditional search engines as they learn based on user behavior and can search by more abstract concepts.

Image from Ross Intelligence

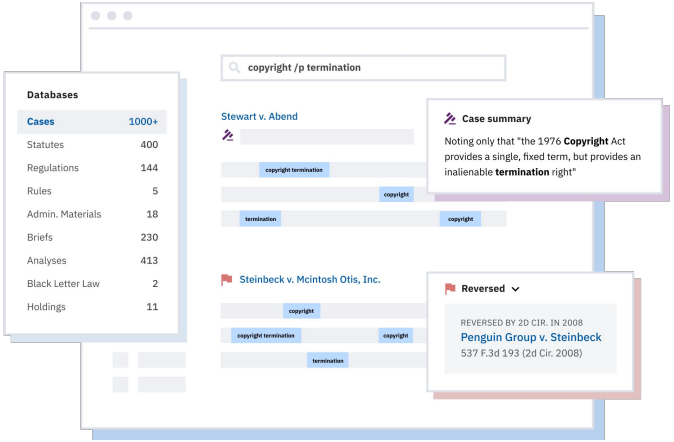


Image from Casetext

Predicting Case Results

Similar systems as those for legal research can be used to predict the arguments of an opposing counsel based on past precedents and the specific counsel's history.

This can also be used to predict case rulings by a judge.

Image from Algorithm-XLab

Other Applications

- E-billing and automatic invoices
- Flagging loopholes or other problematic provisions in contracts
- Automatic reminders for renewing/expiring contracts

Current State of AI in Legal

A primary reason why AI is not currently prevalent in the legal industry is due to the lack of high-quality training data. Without this data, there is nothing for a machine learning model to learn from.

Image from ChannelFutures

Legal AI is a rapidly growing field, however. Many law firms are beginning to integrate AI, and a wide variety of organizations are developing unique software and requisite training data for widespread adoption in the coming years.

References/Read More

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